

baby to descend through your pelvis and into the birth canal. Some women find it hard to squat down comfortably because they are not used to being in this position and tire easily. If this is the case, ask your partner to support you as you squat.

Alternatively, you may find that lying on your side is your preferred position; your partner can help you by supporting one of your legs to keep your pelvis as open as possible. There is also some evidence that lying on your side can protect your perineum from tearing.

Using props Some women find using props such as a beanbag, birthing ball, pillows, or a large cushion while kneeling and leaning forward helpful.